AI X OPS HACKATHON · CASE 1 · CONCEPT NOTE

SiteFirst

A demand-first engine for franchise expansion, from application to an open, trained store

We decide where the business needs a store, then find the right partner for that spot, and get them open.

1 The problem in plain words

- **Expansion today starts with the applicant** ("I have a shop here, give me a franchise"), not with where customers actually are.
- So stores end up **too close together** (they steal each other's sales) or **too far apart** (customers 4–5 km from the nearest store in Bengaluru simply order elsewhere).
- The journey from application to an open store is **slow and leaky**: partners drop off, paperwork stalls, and the expansion team chases everyone by hand.

2 Our big idea: flip the starting point

Applicant-first (today)

Score the applicant → approve if they look good → hope the location works out. Busy zones get one overloaded store; empty zones stay empty.

Company-first (SiteFirst)

Map where demand is → decide how many stores each zone needs → fit the right applicant into each spot → redirect the rest to gaps.

Brands like Lenskart sell both online and in stores. A pin code full of online orders but no store nearby is the strongest signal of where to open next. A very busy zone needs **several stores around it**, not one store in the middle that can't cope.

Demand heatmap: Low · Medium · High · Very high, under-served → top priority

3 How it works: five steps, one flow

STEP 1
Read & clean
"Is the data usable?"
Reads the judges' Excel as-is. Flags missing or contradictory answers (e.g. "Owned space" but no size).

STEP 2
Demand map
"Where do we need stores?"
Heatmap per pin code from online-order demand, territory priority, open slots and distance to existing stores.

STEP 3
Site & payback
"Is it worth it?"
Checks same-pin rule and overlap radius, then estimates revenue and **payback period** for this applicant's investment.

STEP 4
Match & decide
"Who gets which slot?"
When many apply for few slots, assigns across the whole network. Others are redirected to their next-best gap.

STEP 5
Launch plan
"How do they open?"
A personal 60–90 day plan: site, licences, fit-out, staff, and training in Kannada, English or Hindi.

Ask SiteFirst (chat, across all steps): "Why is APP-007 on hold?" gets a plain answer with the numbers behind it. "APP-012 found a ground-floor space" re-runs the engine and updates the decision instantly.

4 Rules that never bend

- **Never two stores in the same pin code**, counting existing stores and new approvals.
- **The brand's priority and open slots decide allocation;** our demand map ranks applicants within that and flags zones that deserve a higher priority.
- **Decisions come from fixed rules, so the same input always gives the same answer.** AI is used only to read messy text and to explain decisions in plain language.

5 What every applicant gets

Decision	What it means	What happens next
Approve	Right spot, right partner, healthy payback	Launch plan starts today
Conditional	Good fit, one gap to close (e.g. ₹5L short, space too small)	Clear condition plus a deadline
Redirect	Partner is good, but their pin is taken or too close to a store	Offered the nearest open gap pin
Waitlist	Good, but a stronger applicant won the last slot	First in line if a slot opens
Hold	Key information missing or contradictory	Exactly what to send, in their language
Reject	Far below minimums, or no viable zone in reach	Polite reason; can reapply later

Example output (illustrative)

APP-007 · Bengaluru 560034 · ₹28L · 3 yrs retail → REDIRECT + CONDITIONAL

- 560034 already has store ST-02, so we can't open here (same-pin rule).
- Nearest gap: **560047**, about 3 km away. High online demand, nearest store over 3 km away, territory priority High.
- Tier 1 needs about ₹35L; you have ₹28L. **Condition:** confirm an extra ₹7L or a co-investor within 30 days.
- **Next:** shortlist 2 ground-floor spaces of 400+ sq ft in 560047 → site visit by week 3 → training in Kannada from week 6.

6 Key assumptions, and how we'd check them

Assumption (starting number)	How we would check it in the real world
Online demand per pin code (**simulated** for this test)	Replace with real order data from the brand's website and app in the pilot
Overlap radius: Tier 1 ~2.5 km · Tier 2 ~4 km · Tier 3 ~7 km	Compare sales of existing stores before and after a nearby opening
Minimum investment: Tier 1 ₹35L · Tier 2 ₹25L · Tier 3 ₹15L	Match against actual fit-out and stock cost of the last 10 stores
Ideal space: ground floor or mall, 400+ sq ft	Ground vs upper-floor sales across existing stores
Good payback: under 30 months · one store serves a fixed order capacity	Actual payback and peak load of current franchisees

7 Who uses it and how we roll it out

Daily users: the expansion team. Instead of chasing every applicant, they only see **exceptions that need a human call**. Applicants get instant, clear answers and a plan. **Why they might resist:** "a tool can't judge a partner" → so every decision shows its reasons, and the team can override with a note.

Pilot · 4 weeks
One city (Mysuru). Tool and team decide side by side; compare results.

Phase 2 · 2 months
All Karnataka cities. Tool decides, team reviews exceptions only.

Phase 3
Plug in real order data; extend to new states.

Metrics that prove it works: days from application to open store · % of approved partners who actually open · how often the team overrides the tool · sales of stores near new openings (no overlap losses).

8 Beyond this case (bonus slide)

The same engine works wherever a business places locations around demand: **Amazon** delivery and pickup points (I Have Space), **Delhivery** franchise delivery centres, food-delivery and QSR outlets, dark stores, and cold-storage hubs. Swap the demand data, keep the logic.